Table 7.2 Protected Areas of India (Jan 2017)

Protected Areas	Number	Total Area in sq Km	% of the Country
National Parks (NPs)	103	40500	1.2
Wild life Sanctuaries (WLSs)	537	118005	3.6
Conservation Reserves (CRs)	67	2350	0.1
Community Reserves	26	47	0.01
Total Protected Areas (PAs)	**733**	**160902**	**4.91**
Source: ENVIS Centre on Wildlife & Protected Areas (http://www.wiienvis.nic.in/Database/ConservationAreas_844.aspx)			

- A National park is an area with ecological, geomorphological and natural significance with rich fauna and flora, designed to protect and to develop wildlife or its environment.
- Activities like grazing, hunting, forestry or cultivation etc. are strictly prohibited.
- No human activity is permitted inside the national park.
- India's first national park was established in 1936 as Hailey National Park, now known as Jim Corbett National Park, Uttarakhand.
- There are 103 national parks in India (National Wildlife Database, April 2015).

Wildlife Sanctuary

- The difference between a Sanctuary and a national park lies mainly in the rights of people living inside. In a Sanctuary, certain rights are allowed but in a national park, no rights are allowed for grazing of any livestock. In a wildlife Sanctuary, the Chief Wildlife Warden may regulate, control or prohibit certain activities.
- There are a total of 537 wildlife sanctuaries in India.

Conservation reserves

- These terms denote the protected areas of India which typically act as buffer zones between established national parks, wildlife sanctuaries and reserved and protected forests of India.
- They are called as '**Conservation Reserves**' if they are uninhabited and completely owned by the Government of India but used for subsistence by communities.

Community Reserves

- They are called '**Community Reserves**' if a part of the land is privately owned.

7. **Biosphere Reserves**: A biosphere reserve is an area of land or water that is protected by law in order to support, sustain and conserve ecosystems.

   Biosphere Reserves of India protect very large areas of natural habitat that are much bigger than national parks or wildlife sanctuaries. Biosphere reserves may cover multiple national parks, sanctuaries and reserves which are contiguous.example, the Nilgiri Biosphere covers: Bandipur National Park, Mudumalai Tiger Reserve, Silent Valley National Park, Nagarhole

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